

The Brightest Bulbs In Town

In a world of cut-throat competition and low attention spans, a projector is the most potent weapon to turn your ideas into business deals. We put eight business projectors to test

Nachiket Mhatre

A picture speaks a thousand words, and it is imperative to have a projector that says all the right things about your sales pitch. People make the common mistake of believing that you can get away with a business projector of average quality and less-than-perfect rendition; after all, PowerPoint presentations and Excel sheets do not need the precision commanded by the more expensive Home Theatre projectors. That is a grave misconception. Just like a hypnotist needs total silence to get into the psyche of his subject, your projector, too, should be free of any imperfections and artefacts that can break the spell and reflect badly on your presentation.

Fortunately for us, the ongoing war between the DLP and LCD projection systems translate into better and more advanced projectors at reduced prices. What was high-end a couple of years ago has now trickled down to the budget segment.

Projectors today are based on the DLP, LCD, LCoS and CRT technologies. With the LCoS and CRT projection systems out of the scope of this test due to their astronomical costs, choosing a business projector boils down to a binary choice between the DLP and LCD systems.

Current-generation DLP and LCD projectors have benefited from refinements of key technologies, giving them better colour accuracy, bright-

ness, contrast, and resolution, which hitherto were the sole prerogative of people with deep pockets. That's precisely why we at the Digit Test Centre have put these projectors through a completely revised test process to bring forth the true picture—warts and all.

Understanding The Features

A proper understanding of a projector's features and their relevance to your requirements is vital. It is imperative to not be swayed by specmanship, gimmicks and features that look good only on paper, but do not justify the extra cost they entail.

Aesthetics

First impressions count. It makes a difference when you whip out a well-sculpted projector, as opposed to something with the aesthetic appeal of a brick.

Resolutions

Featured in this projector shootout were SVGA (800x600) and XGA (1024x768) resolutions.

Choosing the optimum resolution is dependant upon the kind of tasks you'll be using the projector for. SVGA is the way to go if you'll primarily be using the projector for graphs, movies, pictures and presentations without intricate detailing. However, if your projection needs include fine text, computer desktop projection and large spreadsheets, it would be prudent to opt for the more expensive XGA projectors.